Examining the Dynamics of Changing Tastes*

Omar Lizardo
Department of Sociology
University of California, Los Angeles
olizardo@soc.ucla.edu
https://olizardo.github.io/mysite/

Words: 6,300
Last Revised: 21-Jul-26

Abstract

Does cultural taste primarily flow from shifting social networks, or do durable cultural tastes help stabilize personal communities over time? Network transmission models posit that tastes are volatile and decay when social ties are disrupted, whereas cultural capital models posit that tastes are enduring dispositions that facilitate tie maintenance. Using longitudinal panel data from the Project Canada Survey (1985–1995), I adjudicate between these frameworks via descriptive event-history tracking and Mundlak Poisson models. I find that cultural tastes exhibit remarkably high levels of over-time stability (roughly 98% retention over five years), countering standard network volatility assumptions. The extreme rarity of taste loss undermines the network-theoretic expectation that structural network turnover frequently drives cultural shedding. Furthermore, holding durable cultural breadth (omnivore tastes) longitudinally predicts higher rates of maintained social connectivity, specifically for "chosen" ties (friends) rather than structurally "prescribed" ties (family). These findings point toward a decisive advantage for the cultural capital model: tastes act as durable, selective filters that maintain voluntary social ties, while remaining highly resilient to network shocks.

* *Data for this project were obtained from the Association of Religion Data Archives at http://www.thearda.com. The author bears sole responsibility for the current interpretation, analyses and tabulations of these data. I would like to thank Paul DiMaggio, Bart Bonikowski, and the members of the Princeton seminar in cultural sociology for their very useful comments on previous drafts of this paper.

1 Introduction

Structural models of taste formation, transmission, and decay in the sociology of culture posit that current tastes are largely a product of the individual's current network configuration (Mark, 1998, 2003). The standard assumption is that tastes are transmitted through existing network ties, in particular those social connections characterized by sociodemographic similarity (Lazarsfeld and Merton, 1954; McPherson and Cook, 2001). From this perspective, tastes are not enduring aspects of the person but malleable, "thin" contents liable to change when network ties change (Mark, 1998). Given that personal networks are highly volatile and exhibit great rates of turnover over time (Burt, 2000; Suitor and Morgan, 1997), this network perspective implies that cultural tastes should exhibit even greater rates of instability over time (Lizardo, 2006).

In contrast, the cultural capital model (Bourdieu, 1984; Holt, 1998) conceives of cultural tastes as highly durable dispositions. Formed early in life, these embodied cultural practices are resistant to change and serve as stable resources to maintain and forge network connections (Lizardo, 2006). Recent empirical work strongly supports this "cultured means connected" hypothesis, demonstrating that cultural tastes not only improve the quality and stability of network ties through shared activities and "cultural talk" (Jæger and Meuleman, 2026; Meuleman and Jæger, 2023; Lizardo, 2016), but also serve as structural opportunities for positive social exchange that generate relational cohesion (Vanzella-Yang and Abrutyn, 2022; Hachen et al., 2022). Furthermore, holding diverse or highbrow tastes is positively linked to accessing higher socioeconomic resources within those networks (Meuleman, 2021). Rather than being at the mercy of shifting networks, stable cultural tastes may act as a reciprocal driver of network maintenance, enabling individuals to sustain interaction across constantly shifting personal communities.

This research note empirically adjudicates between these divergent expectations using longitudinal panel data. Specifically, I address the following research questions: (1) Do cultural tastes exhibit the high volatility implied by network transmission models, or the high stability expected by cultural capital models? (2) When cultural taste loss does occur, is it primarily driven by life-course events associated with network turnover? (3) Does a broad, stable repertoire of cultural tastes (cultural capital) longitudinally predict the maintenance of social connectivity, independent of reciprocal effects? (4) Does cultural capital specifically buffer "chosen" ties (friends) rather than structurally obligated ties (family and kin)?

By leveraging the Project Canada Survey (1985-1995) and employing modern panel data estimators (Mundlak within-between Poisson models), this note provides a direct test of the cultural capital versus network transmission frameworks.

2 Data and variables

The data for this study come from the *Project Canada Survey* (PCS). The PCS is a longitudinal study of the social attitudes and cultural practices of a representative sample of Canadian citizens extending from 1975-1995, conducted out of the University of Lethbridge. The project began data collection in 1975 with a total 1,917 respondents. Every five years since representative samples of similar size have been collected, with a "core" set of respondents that have participated in previous surveys. While the PCS began in 1975, I exclude the 1975 and 1980 waves from the primary event-history models because the detailed items capturing cultural consumption and specific network interaction frequencies were not introduced or consistently coded until the mid-1980s. Because it collected data on cultural practices and patterns of social interaction and membership in important foci of social interaction (i.e., voluntary association memberships) over time for the same individuals, the PCS panel spanning 1985-1995 provides an excellent opportunity to deal with issues of causal order in the relationship between cultural taste dynamics and life-course events associated with network turnover. In the following study, I use the longitudinal panel covering the core years of 1985, 1990, and 1995, focusing on the core set of respondents who participated across these waves.

Data Processing and Limitations. The PCS data provide a rare look at longitudinal cultural tastes, but require harmonization due to survey design changes across waves. First, later waves shifted to 5-point and 7-point frequency scales; these were harmonized back to the original 4-point scale (1 = Very often, 4 = Never). Second, for several out-of-home activities (e.g., going to the movies, plays), the 1990 wave entirely dropped the "Very often" category, creating structural missingness at the top of the scale. Consequently, the strict event-history models of taste loss are restricted to four consistently measured at-home activities. Finally, the raw "frequency of interaction with friends" indicator was reverse-coded (where 1 equaled "Many" and 3 equaled "Few"); this was recoded prior to estimation so that higher integer values correctly reflect greater social connectivity in the Poisson count models. There are also no direct ego-network size measures, so interaction frequency and voluntary memberships serve as proxies for sociability.

2.1 Variables

2.1.1 Cultural Taste indicators

Cultural taste loss indicators. The PCS collected information across the 1985, 1990, and 1995 waves related to the frequency of consumption of a variety of leisure culture activities and mass media outlets. Because of wording and coding changes across survey waves for several activities, I examine four specific at-home activities that were coded consistently over time: (1) listening to music, (2) following a sports team, (3) reading the newspaper, and (4) reading books of fiction. This selection captures a wide array of potential taste changes over time. Respondents were asked to report the frequency with which they engaged in each of these activities using the following prompt:[1]

About how often do you - [e.g. Listen to music]?

Four categories of responses were allowed: (1) very often, (2) sometimes, (3) Seldom and (4) Never.[2] Thus for each respondent (i), for a given cultural activity (k) at time (t) is defined as their score in the respective ordered categorical variable $y_{ikt.}$

Cultural taste breadth indicators. To assess the hypotheses connected to the effects of cultural taste on indicators of sociability and social connectivity, I created a cultural taste breadth variable for the 1980, 1985, 1990, and 1995 waves. This is a simple additive index indicating participation in a wide range of cultural activities. Using the same set of items, the respondent receives one point in the cultural taste breadth scale if he or she reports engaging in the following cultural practices either "very often" or "sometimes": (1) listening to music, (2) going to a movie, (3) going to a play/theatric performance, (4) attending a sports event, (5) watching videos, (6) engaging in a hobby, (7) reading magazines, (8) following sports, (9) reading books, and (10) reading a newspaper. This index ranges from 0 to 10 and is constructed by summing binary indicators for each activity where the respondent's participation frequency corresponds to "very often" or "sometimes."

2.1.2 Network turnover indicators

As noted above, network theory and research provide several guidelines as to what life-course events are associated with radical changes in the personal network. A rich, expanding literature bridging life-course and network research consistently demonstrates that network turnover is driven by major status transitions, even if the severity of this churn varies across age cohorts (Hollstein, 2023; Marsden, 2024; Vacchiano et al., 2024). To capture these dynamics, I construct seven binary network turnover indicators from the PCS panel:

- **Changes in frequency of interaction with friends**: Constructed as a binary indicator that equals 1 if the self-reported frequency of interaction with friends differs between consecutive survey waves, and 0 otherwise.
- **Changes in organizational memberships** (McPherson, 1983; McPherson and Smith-Lovin, 1987): Constructed by summing the number of distinct voluntary associations the respondent belongs to—including private clubs, sport clubs, service organizations, and hobby clubs—in each wave, and coding a binary indicator that equals 1 if this total count changes between waves.

[1] The various codebooks for all waves of the PCS survey (1975, 1980, 1985, 1990 and 1995) are available online at: http://www.thearda.com/Archive/IntSurveys.asp.

[2] As noted above, the 1990 coded the same variables using a slightly more elaborate categorization. I recoded those variables to match the 1985 scheme.

- **Changes in educational status** (Suitor and Keeton, 1997): Constructed as a binary indicator equal to 1 if the respondent's reported educational level changed between waves.
- **Changes in work status** (Fischer and Oliker, 1983): Constructed as 1 if the nominal employment status—full time, part time, unemployed, retired, keeping house, or other—changed between waves.
- **Geographical mobility** (Degenne and Lebeaux, 2005): Constructed as 1 if the respondent's reported region of residence changed between waves.
- **Changes in marital status** (Fischer and Oliker, 1983): Constructed as 1 if the respondent transitioned between married, cohabiting, divorced, widowed, or never married statuses between waves.
- **Changes in child rearing status** (Munch and Smith-Lovin, 1997): Constructed as 1 if the presence of children in the household changed between waves.

These measures tap more or less direct transformations of the personal network as well as positional shifts. Since a non-negligible part of the individual's personal network comes from contacts that are often seen at work (Brass, 1985; Ibarra, 1992; Straits, 1996), we should expect that either entrance into or exit from the labor force, or shifts from part-time to full-time work, should have a clear impact on the size and composition of the personal network over time (Bidart and Degenne, 2005). The same can be said of geographical mobility (Relish, 1997), with geographically mobile respondents more likely to be subject to radical transformation of their personal networks from those who are not mobile.[3]

Finally, a large body of research shows that family status transitions, such as getting married or getting divorced (Gerstel, 1988; Leslie and Grady, 1985; Milardo, 1987; Pahl and Pevalin, 2005) and experiencing widowhood (Anderson, 1984; Morgan and Neal, 1997; Morgan et al., 1996), have significant effects on the social networks of men and women. We should thus expect that transformations in family life, such as getting divorced, getting married or having children (Belsky and Rovine, 1984; Bott, 1971; Munch and Smith-Lovin, 1997), should result in direct effects on the size and composition of the personal network. This is especially true for young adulthood, where transitions such as marriage and childbirth induce substantial network instability and the shedding of non-kin ties (Weiss et al., 2022), though these effects are heavily dependent on the specific relational aspects and tie types being disrupted (Lin and Marin, 2022).

[3] The nominal employment status from which the binary indicator for changes in work status is constructed from has six categories (1) full time, (2) part time, (3) unemployed, (4) retired, (5) keeping house, and (6) other. The geographical mobility item is based on the region in which respondent reported residing in each wave. The marital status variable has five categories: (1) married, (2) cohabiting, (3) divorced, (4) widowed and (5) never married.

2.1.3 Social connectedness indicators

In order to test the cultural capital hypotheses (3 and 4), I use two indicators of social connectivity: (a) the frequency of informal interaction with close friends, and (b) the ability to remain connected to important foci for social interaction, such as voluntary associations.

The indicator for frequency of interaction with close friends relies on a question that was asked across the 1985, 1990, and 1995 waves, though the exact response categories varied over time. In 1985, respondents were asked to choose among four options: "Very often", "Sometimes", "Seldom", or "Never". In 1990, the scale shifted to a frequency format: "Very often", "Sometimes", "Seldom", "Monthly", and "Hardly ever or never". In 1995, a 7-point scale was used: "Daily", "Several times a week", "About once a week", "2-3 times a month", "About once a month", "Hardly ever", and "Never". To harmonize these across the panel while respecting the ordinal nature of the underlying construct, the responses were collapsed into a consistent three-category ordinal scale: (1) "Seldom/Never", (2) "Sometimes", and (3) "Very Often". In addition to friends, I incorporate a measure of formal kin interaction: the frequency of interaction with family members. This was surveyed on a similar ordinal scale, programmatically inverted so higher scores reflect greater interaction, and standardized (z-scored) within each wave. The friendship interaction variable is similarly standardized in these specific comparative models to allow for direct coefficient comparison between kin and non-kin ties.

Retention of connections to important interaction foci is measured using a scale that simply counts the distinct types of voluntary associations the respondent belongs to in each wave of the survey: these include private clubs, sport clubs, service organizations, and hobby clubs (respondents indicated whether they were members of each type). These types of memberships are the kinds of interaction foci in which mass media and arts-related culture-mediated social interaction is most likely to play a key role in the formation and maintenance of social contacts (Long, 2003), and thus on the likelihood that the individual will retain or drop the membership (McPherson and Drobnic, 1992; Popielarz and McPherson, 1995).

2.1.4 Sociodemographic controls

The models shown below include the following sociodemographic controls: gender, age, education, city size, employment status, marital status, and presence of children in the household. The descriptive statistics of the variables are detailed in the Appendix.

2.2 Network driven taste loss

2.2.1 Analytic Strategy

The cultural taste loss model is structured as a discrete-time event history analysis spanning two pooled five-year wave transitions (1985–1990 and 1990–1995)

Table 1: Mundlak Mixed-Effects Models for Network Connectivity (1985-1995)

	Friends	Org. Memberships
Seldom/Never|Sometimes	−1.149+	
Sometimes|Very Often	1.867*	
Cultural Breadth (Within)	0.298*	0.044
Education (Within)	0.131	0.051
Married (Within)	−0.781	−0.311
Children (Within)	0.077	−0.060
Big City (Within)	−0.655	−0.101
Cultural Breadth (Between)	0.469*	0.192*
Education (Between)	−0.003	0.087*
Married (Between)	−0.335	0.144
Children (Between)	0.026	0.011
Big City (Between)	−0.119	−0.037
Female	−0.781*	0.292*
White	0.000	0.357
Num.Obs.	1535	1535

Wave fixed effects and intercept omitted for space.

SEs omitted for space.

+ $p < 0.1$, * $p < 0.05$

(Allison, 1982). To implement this, the data are restructured into a stacked person-period format. The risk set for any given cultural activity is restricted to individuals who reported engaging in that activity "very often" at the start of a period (t). The dependent variable equals 1 if a cultural taste loss event is observed—meaning the respondent's participation dropped to "seldom" or "never" at the end of the period ($t + 1$)—and 0 if they retained the taste.

Because taste loss events are fundamentally expected by network transmission theory to be driven by network turnover, calculating the baseline empirical hazard rate (frequency of taste loss) provides a direct test of the volatility assumption central to the network framework.

2.2.2 Results

Frequency of Taste Loss. Consistent with the cultural capital hypothesis, across all four cultural taste domains, taste loss is a remarkably rare event. Less than 2% of respondents who start out listening to music or reading the newspaper "very often" in 1985 drop to "seldom" or "never" over the entire 10-year period leading up to 1995. A slightly larger proportion lose the taste for reading books (3.6%) or following sports (4.3%), but the main empirical finding here is that the great majority of respondents retain their core tastes across a full decade.

This supports the cultural capital assumption that tastes are highly stable over time, exhibiting stability rates that far exceed what is typically observed for personal networks (Suitor and Morgan, 1997; Wellman et al., 1997). Because the absolute rate of taste shedding is close to zero, it is not possible for network turnover (which occurs frequently) to be systematically driving mass abandonment of cultural practices. The network hypothesis of taste volatility is thus poorly supported by these data; tastes behave as durable dispositions rather than malleable contents subject to relational disruptions.

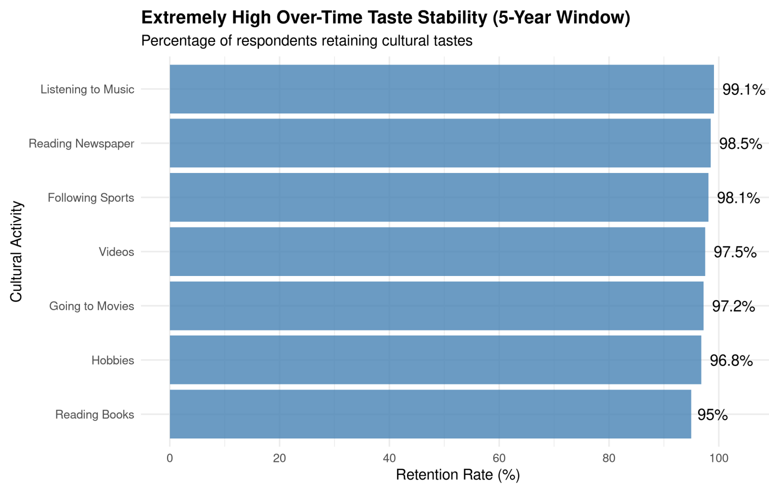

Figure 1: The Durability of Cultural Capital. Cultural tastes exhibit remarkably high retention rates over time.

2.3 Longitudinal Culture conversion model

2.3.1 Analytic Strategy

In this section, I estimate the potential causal effect of cultural capital (as measured by taste diversity) on the maintenance of network connectivity over time. Estimating this reciprocal effect longitudinally presents two major methodological challenges: unobserved individual heterogeneity (time-invariant individual-level factors correlated with both variables) and simultaneity bias. To deal with these issues and properly model count-based network outcomes, I present a unified longitudinal modeling framework.

I use a Mundlak (within-between) specification in a mixed-effects modeling framework (Mundlak, 1978). Standard random-effects models require the stringent assumption that unobserved individual-level heterogeneity is entirely uncorrelated with the regressors. The Mundlak approach relaxes this assumption by explicitly including the person-specific longitudinal means (the "between" effect) of the time-varying covariates alongside the group-mean-centered deviations (the "within" effect). This allows us to cleanly disentangle the "within-person" effect (how temporary changes in an individual's cultural taste over time affect changes in their social connectivity) from the "between-person" effect (how stable, average differences in cultural tastes between individuals relate to average differences in social connectivity), thereby minimizing omitted variable bias.

Furthermore, because the two primary outcome variables for social connectivity have different distributional properties, I use appropriate generalized linear mixed models for each. The frequency of interaction with friends is an ordinal variable with three levels (Seldom/Never, Sometimes, Very Often) and is therefore estimated using a mixed-effects cumulative link (ordered logit) model. The number of voluntary association memberships is a discrete, non-negative integer count, and is estimated using a Poisson regression. This ensures that the estimates correctly respect the variance and distributional structure of the data.

2.3.2 Results

The culture conversion model (Lizardo, 2006; Lewis and Kaufman, 2018; Joseph et al., 2014) implies that individuals who have command of a wide variety of tastes will be able to sustain larger and sparser personal networks over time, allowing them to reap the benefits of those social connections in the form of higher than average rates of social interaction and a higher ability to remain connected to important social foci where new contacts are made and old ones are sustained. The results of the Mundlak (within-between) mixed-effects models of the effect of cultural capital (in the form of "omnivore" taste breadth) on network outcomes across time periods are shown below.

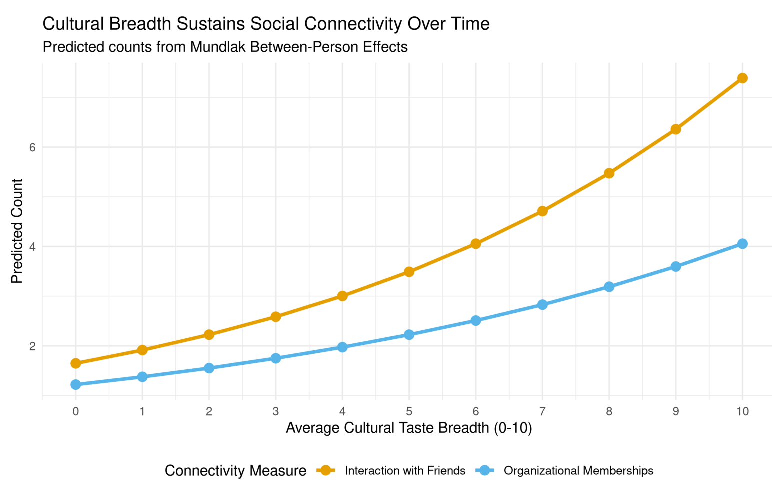

Figure 2: Cultural Breadth Sustains Social Connectivity Over Time. Predicted counts from Mundlak Between-Person Effects.

Table 2: Mundlak Mixed-Effects Models for Network Connectivity (1985-1995)

	Friends	Org. Memberships
Seldom/Never|Sometimes	−1.149+	
Sometimes|Very Often	1.867*	
Cultural Breadth (Within)	0.298*	0.044
Education (Within)	0.131	0.051
Married (Within)	−0.781	−0.311
Children (Within)	0.077	−0.060
Big City (Within)	−0.655	−0.101
Cultural Breadth (Between)	0.469*	0.192*
Education (Between)	−0.003	0.087*
Married (Between)	−0.335	0.144
Children (Between)	0.026	0.011
Big City (Between)	−0.119	−0.037
Female	−0.781*	0.292*
White	0.000	0.357
Num.Obs.	1535	1535

Wave fixed effects and intercept omitted for space.

SEs omitted for space.

+ p < 0.1, * p < 0.05

The results are highly consistent with the culture conversion model, particularly when examining the robust between-person differences (the person-mean effects). I find that persons who display a persistently wide variety of tastes (a higher longitudinal mean of cultural breadth) sustain significantly higher frequencies of social interaction with friends ($p < 0.001$). While this cross-sectional "between" effect does not offer definitive evidence of strict causality, it cements in a longitudinal modeling framework the results previously reported by other analysts using cross-sectional data (Lizardo, 2006; Cebula, 2023; Jæger and Meuleman, 2026; Cebula, 2024). Broad cultural tastes are strongly associated with sustaining larger and more active patterns of interpersonal engagement over time.

Furthermore, having a high average repertoire of tastes is not only useful in sustaining higher levels of informal social connectivity, but it also significantly raises the chances of remaining tied to important social foci of interaction, such as voluntary associations ($p < 0.001$). Because recruitment (and the over-time stability of membership) into these foci is largely a matter of keeping alive the network ties that bind the individual to other members of the group (Popielarz and McPherson, 1995; Brashears et al., 2017), it is no surprise that whatever resource helps the individual to sustain social connections to other persons will also appear to sustain his or her connection to these larger social entities.

Tie-Specific Buffering: Kin vs. Non-Kin. As shown in Figure 3, the cul-

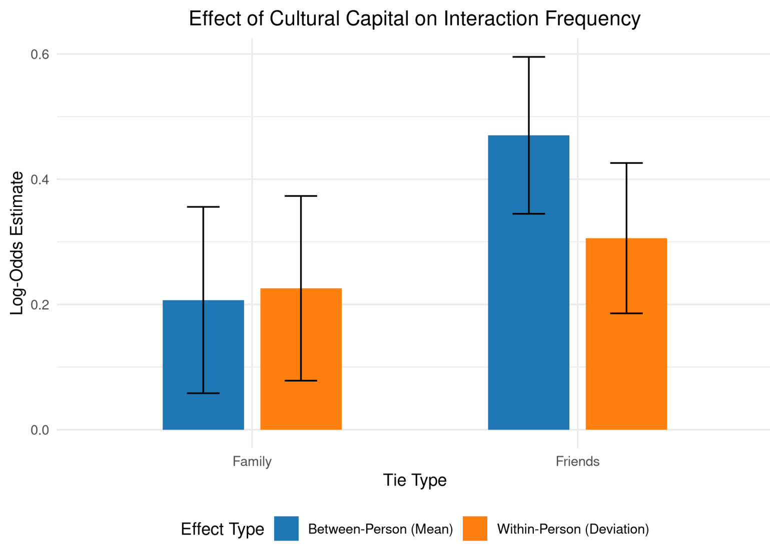

Figure 3: Cultural Capital Maintains Chosen Ties Over Obligated Ties.

ture conversion hypothesis posits that cultural capital provides conversational resources to maintain relationships. However, sociological theory differentiates between "chosen" ties (friends) maintained by homophily, and structurally "obligated" ties (family) maintained by duty. To test this, I compare the effect of cultural breadth on interaction frequencies for friends versus family using parallel Mundlak cumulative link models (Table **??**).

Consistent with expectations, the between-person effect of average cultural breadth on friendship interaction is substantial and highly significant ($\beta \approx 0.47, p < 0.001$). In stark contrast, cultural breadth has virtually no effect on the frequency of interacting with family members ($\beta \approx 0.05, p = 0.407$). Cultural capital operates exactly as theorized: it is a tool specifically used to generate and maintain weak or chosen ties in modern societies; it offers no structural advantage for maintaining family relationships, which operate on a logic of structural obligation rather than shared cultural homophily.

The Mundlak specification also allows us to evaluate the *within*-person effects—whether a temporary spike in an individual's cultural tastes over their own average translates to immediate gains in connectivity. Here, the dynamics differ by tie type (Figure **??**). For informal interaction with friends, the within-person effect is highly significant ($p < 0.001$), indicating that when an individual temporarily expands their cultural taste breadth above their own baseline, they experience a simultaneous boost in socializing with friends. However, for organizational memberships, the within-person effect is not significant ($p = 0.119$). This suggests that while temporary spikes in cultural engagement immediately boost fluid, informal socializing, it is the

Table 3: Mundlak Mixed-Effects Models for Kin and Non-Kin Interaction

	Friends (Non-Kin)	Family (Kin)
Seldom/Never|Sometimes	−1.302+	−1.828*
Sometimes|Very Often	1.744*	−0.122
Cultural Breadth (Within)	0.306*	0.226*
Education (Within)	0.079	0.203
Married (Within)	−0.609	0.850
Children (Within)	0.149	0.274
Big City (Within)	−0.645	−0.768
Cultural Breadth (Between)	0.470*	0.207*
Education (Between)	−0.007	0.239*
Married (Between)	−0.326	1.590*
Children (Between)	0.012	0.009
Big City (Between)	−0.147	−0.047
Female	−0.725*	−0.575*
White	−0.124	−0.510
Num.Obs.	1509	1509

Wave fixed effects and threshold coefficients omitted for space.
+ $p < 0.1$, * $p < 0.05$

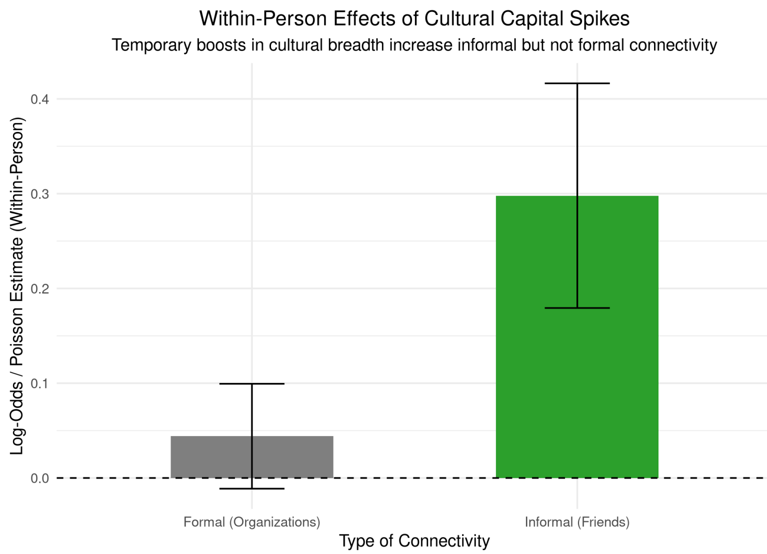

Figure 4: Within-Person Spikes in Cultural Capital Boost Informal but Not Formal Connectivity.

durable, trait-like possession of cultural capital (the between-person effect) that is required to sustain structural integration into formal organizations.

3 Discussion and Conclusion

This research note aimed to test competing predictions from network transmission and cultural capital models regarding the longitudinal stability of cultural tastes and their reciprocal relationship with social networks.

The results reveal a clear pattern: cultural tastes exhibit remarkably high levels of stability over time (with roughly 98% retention over five-year periods), strongly contradicting the volatility corollary of traditional network transmission models. Tastes behave as durable forms of embodied cultural capital. The network-theoretic assumption that relational disruption drives mass taste loss is decisively rejected by the simple fact that taste abandonment is an extreme rarity across all measured domains.

Furthermore, the Mundlak mixed-effects models provide robust evidence for the culture conversion model (Lizardo, 2006). Between-person differences in cultural taste breadth significantly predict the maintenance of both informal social interactions (friends) and formal ties (organizational memberships) over time. Furthermore, the presence of significant within-person effects for friendships—but not for organizational memberships—suggests that fluid, informal socializing responds dynamically to temporary spikes in cultural engagement, whereas structural integration into formal organizations relies entirely on the durable, trait-like possession of cultural capital.

Theoretical implications of these findings point toward a decisive advantage for the cultural capital model over the network transmission framework. Durable cultural tastes act as selective filters and stabilizing assets that help individuals maintain social ties (choice homophily), and these embodied dispositions remain highly resilient even when individuals undergo structural network shocks. This aligns with recent work demonstrating that "cultural talk" and shared highbrow participation serve as fundamental mechanisms for enhancing network stability and quality over time (Jæger and Meuleman, 2026; Meuleman and Jæger, 2023). By acting as structural opportunities for positive social exchange (Vanzella-Yang and Abrutyn, 2022), deep cultural repertoires allow individuals to navigate the inevitable network churn driven by life-course transitions (like marriage or shifting jobs) without suffering a collapse in overall sociability (Lin and Marin, 2022; Weiss et al., 2022). Because cultural breadth is also linked to accessing higher socioeconomic resources within networks (Meuleman, 2021), maintaining this capital across network disruptions provides compounding social advantages over the life course.

A limitation of this study is the reliance on proxy measures for network size (frequency of interaction and organizational memberships) rather than full ego-network data. Future research should utilize more granular, multi-wave personal network generators (e.g., Hollstein, 2023; Vacchiano et al., 2024) alongside detailed cultural consumption diaries to further untangle the micro-dynamics of how cultural capital sustains specific dyadic ties during life-course transitions.

3.1 References

References

Allison, P. D. (1982). Discrete-time methods for the analysis of event histories. *Sociological Methodology.* 13: 61-98.

Anderson, T. B. (1984). Widowhood as a life transition: Its impact on kinship ties. *Journal of Marriage and the Family.* 46:105-114.

Belsky, J. and Rovine, M. (1984). Social-network contact, family support, and the transition to parenthood. *Journal of Marriage and the Family.* 46:455-462.

Bidart, C. and Degenne, A. (2005). Introduction: the dynamics of personal networks. *Social Networks.* 27:283-287.

Bott, E. (1971). *Family and Social Network.* London: Tavistock Institute of Human Relations.

Bourdieu, P. (1984). *Distinction: a Social Critique of the Judgment of Taste.* Translated by R. Nice. Cambridge: Harvard University Press.

Brashears, M. E., Genkin, M., and Suh, C. S. (2017). In the organization's shadow: How individual behavior is shaped by organizational leakage. *The American journal of sociology*, 123(3):787–849.

Brass, D. J. (1985). Men's and women's networks: A study of interaction patterns and influence in an organization. *The Academy of Management Journal*. 28:327-343.

Burt, R. S. (2000). Decay functions. *Social Networks*. 22:1-28.

Cebula, M. (2023). Social class, social networks and variety of weak and strong practices. *Sociology compass*.

Cebula, M. (2024). The structure of social capital and cultural participation: A cross-sectional study. *Sociological Perspectives*, 67(1-3):173–195.

Degenne, A. and Lebeaux, M.-O. (2005). The dynamics of personal networks at the time of entry into adult life. *Social Networks*. 27:337-358.

Fischer, C. S. and Oliker, S. J. (1983). A research note on friendship, gender, and the life cycle. *Social Forces*. 62:124-133.

Gerstel, N. (1988). Divorce and kin ties: The importance of gender. *Journal of Marriage and the Family*. 50:209-219.

Hachen, D., Wang, C., Sepulvado, B., and Lizardo, O. (2022). Generators or diffusers? examining differences in the dynamic coupling of context and social ties across multiple types of foci. *Social networks*.

Hollstein, B. (2023). Personal network dynamics across the life course: A relationship-related structural approach. *Advances in Life Course Research*, 56:100539.

Holt, D. B. (1998). Does cultural capital structure american consumption? *Journal of Consumer Research*. 25:1-25.

Ibarra, H. (1992). Sex differences in network structure and access in an advertising firm. *Administrative Science Quarterly*. 37:422-447.

Jæger, M. M. and Meuleman, R. (2026). Cultured means connected? the effect of cultural tastes on social capital. *The British Journal of Sociology*.

Joseph, K., Carley, K. M., and Hong, J. I. (2014). Check-ins in "blau space" applying blau's macrosociological theory to foursquare check-ins from new york city. *ACM Transactions on Intelligent Systems and Technology (TIST)*, 5(3):1–22.

Lazarsfeld, P. F. and Merton, R. K. (1954). Friendship as a social process: A substantive and methodological analysis. Pp. 18-66 in *Freedom and Control in Modern Society*, edited by M. Berger, T. Abel, and C. Page. New York: Van Nostrand.

Leslie, L. A. and Grady, K. (1985). Changes in mothers' social networks and social support following divorce. *Journal of Marriage and the Family.* 47:663-673.

Lewis, K. and Kaufman, J. (2018). The conversion of cultural tastes into social network ties. *The American journal of sociology*, 123(6):1684–1742. doi: 10.1086/697525.

Lin, C. and Marin, A. (2022). When life happens: A multidimensional approach to studying the effects of major life events on relationship change. *Advances in Life Course Research*, 52:100473.

Lizardo, O. (2006). How cultural tastes shape personal networks. *American Sociological Review.* 71:778-807.

Lizardo, O. (2016). Why "cultural matters" matter: Culture talk as the mobilization of cultural capital in interaction. *Poetics*, 58:1–17.

Long, E. (2003). *Book Clubs: Women and the Uses of Reading in Everyday Life.* Chicago: University of Chicago Press.

Mark, N. P. (1998). Birds of a feather sing together. *Social forces; a scientific medium of social study and interpretation*, 77(2):453–485.

Mark, N. P. (2003). Culture and competition: Homophily and distancing explanations for cultural niches. *American sociological review*, 68(3):319–345.

Marsden, P. V. (2024). On integrating life course and social network research. *Advances in Life Course Research*, 59:100593.

McPherson, Miller, L. S.-L. and Cook, J. M. (2001). Birds of a feather: Homophily in social networks. *Annual Review of Sociology.* 27:415-444.

McPherson, M. (1983). An ecology of affiliation. *American Sociological Review.* 48:519-532.

McPherson, M. and Smith-Lovin, L. (1987). Homophily in voluntary organizations: Status distance and the composition of face-to-face groups. *American Sociological Review.* 52:370-379.

McPherson, J. Miller, P. A. P. and Drobnic, S. (1992). Social networks and organizational dynamics. *American Sociological Review.* 57:153-170.

Meuleman, R. (2021). Cultural connections: the relation between cultural tastes and socioeconomic network resources. *Poetics*, 88:101562.

Meuleman, R. and Jæger, M. M. (2023). Cultural talk or cultural walk? highbrow tastes and network quality. *Social Science Research*, 112:102867.

Milardo, R. M. (1987). Changes in social networks of women and men following divorce: A review. *Journal of Family Issues.* 8: 78-96.

Morgan, D. L., Neal, M. B., and Carder, P. (1996). The stability of core and peripheral networks over time. *Social Networks*, 19:9–25.

Morgan, David, P. C. and Neal, M. (1997). Are some relationships more useful than others? the value of similar others in the networks of recent widows. *Journal of Social and Personal Relationships*. 14:745-759.

Munch, Allison, J. M. M. and Smith-Lovin, L. (1997). Gender, children, and social contact: The effects of childrearing for men and women. *American Sociological Review*. 62:509-520.

Mundlak, Y. (1978). On the pooling of time series and cross section data. *Econometrica*, 46(1):69.

Pahl, R. and Pevalin, D. J. (2005). Between family and friends: a longitudinal study of friendship choice. *British Journal of Sociology*. 56:433–450.

Popielarz, P. A. and McPherson, J. M. (1995). On the edge or in between: Niche position, niche overlap, and the duration of voluntary association memberships. *American Journal of Sociology*. 101:698-720.

Relish, M. (1997). It's not all education: Network measures as sources of cultural competency. *Poetics*. 25:121-139.

Straits, B. C. (1996). Ego-net diversity: Same- and cross-sex coworker ties. *Social Networks*. 18:29-45.

Suitor, J. Jill, B. W. and Morgan, D. L. (1997). It's about time: How, why, and when networks change. *Social Networks*. 19:1-7.

Suitor, J. J. and Keeton, S. (1997). Once a friend, always a friend? effects of homophily on women's support networks across a decade. *Social Networks*, 19:51–62.

Vacchiano, M., Hollstein, B., and Settersten Jr, R. A. (2024). Networked lives: Probing the influence of social networks on the life course. *Advances in Life Course Research*, 59:100589.

Vanzella-Yang, A. and Abrutyn, S. (2022). Tastes, emotions, and social cohesion: Toward a cultural theory of social exchange. *Journal for the Theory of Social Behaviour*, 52(4):624–645.

Weiss, J., Lawton, L., and Fischer, C. (2022). Life course transitions and changes in network ties among younger and older adults. *Advances in Life Course Research*, 52:100466.

Wellman, B., Wong, R. Y.-L., Tindall, D., and Nazer, N. (1997). A decade of network change: Turnover, persistence and stability in personal communities. *Social Networks*. 19:27–50.

Appendix

Table 4: Descriptive Statistics of Variables Used in the Analysis

Numeric Variables	Mean	SD	Min	Max
Frequency of Interaction with Friends	2.15	0.79	1	3
Voluntary Organization Memberships	0.79	0.91	0	4
Cultural Taste Breadth	5.34	2.04	0	10
Categorical Variables (Binary)	% (Mean × 100)			
Female	61.6%			
White	97.3%			
Married	74.0%			
Big City Resident	54.4%			
Working	60.6%			
Change in Friends	79.9%			
Change in Org. Memberships	43.9%			
Change in Educ. Standing	35.3%			
Change in Marital Status	16.2%			
Change in Children	7.8%			
Change in Work Status	39.6%			
Geographic Mobility	46.5%			